One student, a dentist in real life (as I recall), after it had been established that I did quite a bit of writing, asked how much money I made in this way.

I hesitated, and then said, "About as much as I make at my job as an instructor."

He laughed and said, with what I took as a sneer, "That's all?"

I would have answered angrily, but Pratt intervened, and scolded him for his impoliteness to someone who was trying to be of service to them.

There were still three days to go, but one of the students was driving back to Boston that day and invited me to come with him, and on impulse, I went. The dentist's remark was the deciding factor, I think.

*5

At about this time, Heinlein forged another advance, for both himself and for the science-fiction world in general. He was science adviser to Destination: Moon, the first intelligent science-fiction movie made.

I went to see it, with considerable excitement, after I got back from Breadloaf. I was willing to overlook the Cold War jingoism at the start, and some minor unlikelinesses such as a lunar surface that seemed to be composed of dried-out sediment.

What bothered me and, indeed, ruined the picture for me, was that an amateur actor, whom I had never seen before and have never seen since, was hired to portray a comic stowaway from Brooklyn. Aside from the fact that the comic Brooklynite was a weary cliche" and that Heinlein, remembering me, might have avoided it, there might at least have been some attempt to get a Brooklynite to do it. There must, after all, be thousands of transplanted Brooklynites in Los Angeles. Instead, the character chosen to play the part could not duplicate the Brooklyn accent. It was painful to listen to what he thought was a Brooklyn accent.

16

On August 28, I got my car back and had a sudden inspiration. Why not take advantage of my mobility to have a pleasant lunch?

I was accustomed to eating lunch at the local Howard Johnson's, which was good enough for the peasantry, but surely now that I had a car, I could drive